


# ELECTION GUIDELINES 2026-27

## ELECTION COMMISSION

## BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE

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## SECTION 1 – General Guidelines

1. A manifesto must be carried at **all times** while campaigning.
2. Candidates may be campaigned for only by their registered campaigners.
3. Door-to-door campaigning should take place within hostel rooms only. No campaigning is allowed in common rooms, messes, corridors, etc.
4. At any given time during campaigning, the group size inside a room must not exceed 8 members, including the campaigner(s). This also includes the candidate in question [if present].
5. Male candidates for President and General Secretary and their campaigners may reach out to the EC to campaign to the Meera Bhawan residents.
6. Female Candidates contesting for the position of the General Secretary or the President and their female campaigners are permitted access to the Boys' Hostel common rooms with prior permission from the Election Commission and upon issue of necessary I.D. cards.
7. Campaigning can only be done during the given time slots:
    a. Monday – Friday: 1700 hrs to 2359 hrs
    b. Saturday/Sunday/holidays: 1000 hrs to 2359 hrs
8. Only SU / SSMS supported / Sports Union / Institute-backed activities undertaken by the candidate in the past may be spoken about by the campaigners.
9. The campaigner(s) may not refer to any of the other candidates or their manifesto points by name or any other means. If negative references to the same are made, the case shall be treated as one of either anti-campaigning or character assassination, as seen fit, and shall be dealt with as detailed in Section 8.
10. Alliances may not be formed between candidates. Any alliances so formed will be considered flagrant violations of the guidelines and will have severe consequences.
11. A candidate shall not be allowed to contest for two posts lasting for the same term. This, in effect, means that the candidate shall not be allowed to simultaneously contest for the posts of Hostel Representative, Day Scholar Representative, Mess Representative, Hostel Sports Representative, President, or General Secretary for the duration of the term beginning September 2026.
12. Candidates holding offices in the Students' Union or organs of the Students' Union, SSMS, or Sports Union shall be required to resign from the respective posts before submitting their nomination.
13. Prospective candidates are advised to note that any form of activity that amounts to campaigning, any deliberate attempt to influence the elections or undermine the election guidelines before the commencement of the official campaigning period shall be deemed as a violation of the election guidelines and dealt with during the election process.

14. Prospective candidates are required to remove their names from any initiatives that do not fall under the purview of the Students' Union, SSMS, or the Institute. This includes publicising initiatives via mail and other mediums of online communication.
15. No post holder/member in the Union Council, SSMS, or Sports Union shall be allowed to campaign for or publicly back any candidate. In the event that a StuCCAn, CoStAAn, or CRC member is found to be backing a candidate, the individual in question shall face penalties in accordance with the relevant sections of the Constitution.
16. The campaigner(s) may not mention the backing of the candidate by previous President(s), General Secretary(ies) or Hostel Representative(s), if any.

## SECTION 2 – Communicating with the Electorate

1. Pamphlets and brochures may not be distributed.
2. No monetary or material incentives may be offered.
3. Except as specifically permitted under Section 1, no campaigning of any form is permitted inside the institute.
4. No campaigning of any form is permitted outside the campus.
5. Sloganeering and processions or large meets of any form are strictly disallowed.
6. No badges of any sort are permitted.
7. No P.A. systems, music (including raps, poems, or songs of any form), or entertainment or refreshment stalls may be employed during the campaign.
8. Animals may not be used for campaigning.
9. Banners of any kind are not permitted to be used.
10. Defacement of manifestos, etc. is not permitted.
11. All surveys conducted by candidates during the campaign period and/or surveys used by candidates for campaigning must first be deemed legitimate by the Election Commission, and the onus of ensuring the legitimacy of the conduct of such surveys lies with the respective candidate and that candidate only.
12. Lettering of walls, defacement of Bhawans, mess or institute buildings, painting on roads, etc. is not permitted.
13. Forcible campaigning of any sort is not permitted. The campaigners are to refrain from aggressively campaigning to those who do not wish to be campaigned to.

## SECTION 3 – Financial

1. The candidate or their campaigners may not spend **any** money for their campaign.

## SECTION 4 – Nomination Process

1. Once the call for nominations is displayed, prospective candidates can put forward their names following the procedure mentioned.
2. The nomination process entails a prospective candidate submitting their nomination and a deposit of Rs. 400 and Rs. 700 for a Hostel Representative and President / General Secretary nomination, respectively.
3. Along with the nomination form, candidates are expected to submit a manifesto, statement of purpose (SOP), and proof of all claims made by the candidate before 11:59 pm, 19th August 2026, Wednesday (EOD).
4. Each manifesto point submitted by the candidate shall be colour-coded by the EC based on the nature of proof provided and the extent to which the claim has been substantiated. Failure to submit any proof or non-adherence to aforementioned deadlines will result in a watermark regarding the same on the manifesto, as deemed fit by the EC.
5. A hard copy of the list of campaigners, along with their signatures, must be submitted to the EC. A soft copy of the same must be emailed to the official EC mail, keeping all the campaigners in the CC.
6. Candidates contesting for the posts of Hostel Sports Representative or Mess Representative may not serve as official campaigners for any Union Council candidate.
7. The candidate may withdraw their nomination any time before the specified date for the same. If they do not wish to contest elections but fail to withdraw within the given deadline, they stand to lose their deposit.

## SECTION 5 – Informational Seminar

1. The Election Commission will brief the candidates and the GBM about the campaigning guidelines and other relevant information.
2. The seminar will be moderated by the EC.

**The following applies only to candidates contesting for the posts of President / General Secretary:**

1. Each candidate is given a maximum of 7 minutes to speak. This time limit may strictly not be exceeded.
2. The candidate may, if they deem fit, restate their statement of purpose.
3. The candidate's speech should include, for each manifesto point,
    a. The need, and the present situation,
    b. The work completed thus far, and
    c. The work that needs to be done in the future.
4. Each candidate is permitted to ask up to three questions to other candidates standing for the same post as them. However, one candidate may not ask more than two questions to another particular candidate. The EC may dismiss a question if it is found to harm the sanctity of the election process.

## SECTION 6 – Auditorium Debate

1. The Auditorium Debate will focus on the feasibility of the manifesto points, as well as the preparedness of the candidates standing for the posts of President and General Secretary.
2. The candidates will be responding to queries raised by a panel of senior students assembled by the EC.
3. Post the Informational Seminar (Section 5), a link will be opened for the GBM to raise any queries they have about the candidates' manifesto points. These may be put forward to the candidates during the Debate by the said panel, if deemed fit.
4. For the Auditorium Debate, candidates are required to submit documents/proofs substantiating their manifesto points. These proofs should be of a written nature, and no verbal acknowledgments will be accepted.

## SECTION 7 – Common Room Debate

1. The Common Room Debate will focus on the feasibility of the manifesto points, as well as the preparedness of the candidates standing for the posts of H-Reps and D-Reps.
2. The candidates will be responding to queries raised by member(s) of the EC, competing candidates, and members of the concerned electorate.
3. For the Common Room Debate, candidates are required to submit documents/proofs substantiating their manifesto points. These proofs should be of a written nature, and no verbal acknowledgments will be accepted.

## SECTION 8 – Violations of Electioneering Norms

Failing to adhere to any of the above-mentioned guidelines would be deemed a violation and shall be dealt with based on the severity of the same. Any complaints or information regarding the same should be brought to the notice of the EC at the earliest. Any complaint will have to be backed by sufficient evidence.

The actions taken can be one of, but not limited to:

1. Curtailing the campaigning time period and/or restricting the social media reach of a candidate. The decision by the EC shall be final in this regard.
2. Reduction in votes for that candidate. The decision by the EC shall be final in this regard.
3. Disqualification of the candidate in question. The decision by the EC shall be final in this regard.
4. In the event of a candidate's disqualification, the candidate in question shall be permanently barred from contesting for any post within the Students' Union in the future. The EC's decision in this regard shall be final and binding.
5. Reporting the candidate/individual in question to the Institute authorities, if found guilty of any actions against the rules of the Institute.

## SECTION 9 – General Campaigning Rules

1. Each candidate is required to declare an official team of campaigners for the election. Communication from these specified individuals alone will be treated as an official source of information for their campaign.
    a. This official list of these campaigners and their submitted details that the candidate submits to the EC will be made public to the GBM.
    b. No other member of the General Body apart from those declared as campaigners by the candidate will be allowed to indulge in campaigning.
2. Violation of the above clause by any General Body Member will lead to a retributive action as found fit by the Institute.
3. Candidates and/or campaigners will be required to ask for consent from the individual that is contacted in the very beginning of any campaign-related correspondence.
    a. No individual may be aggressively campaigned to if they do not wish to be campaigned to. In cases where an individual has expressed displeasure at the campaigning on any social media group/page, any further campaigning on the same would be dealt with as

detailed in Section 8.

b. Forcible campaigning in any form is not allowed. The camps must take note of those individuals who expressed displeasure at being campaigned to and make sure that no member of the camp campaigns to the individual again. The individual may approach the EC if they are being campaigned to despite expressing their displeasure, and the issue would be dealt with as detailed in Section 8.

4. Any form of anti-campaigning/slandering against individuals involved in the election process directly or indirectly is banned on all forums. In case of a violation, the admins of such anonymous forums/pages would be held responsible and dealt with as mentioned in Section 8 of the guidelines.
5. Any individual either directly involved in aggressive campaigning or anti-campaigning or abetting the process will also be held complicit.

## SECTION 10 – Online Campaigning

1. One-to-one campaigning to any member of the General Body on online forums is NOT allowed.
2. All campaigning-related material, whether written, recorded, or oral, needs to be approved by the EC before being published.
3. Designated WhatsApp groups shall be allowed to be made for campaigning purposes. Candidates may use these groups to make public announcements regarding their campaign within the mandated campaigning timeline as specified.
    a. These groups will be monitored by the EC (who will be co-admins of the group along with the candidates and/or their official campaign team).
    b. Any member of the General Body can only be added with their prior consent, and they are free to quit the group at any time.
    c. The settings of these groups will remain admins-only at all times.
4. Campaigning on social media channels:
    a. Each candidate would be allowed to post a 5-minute video on the official EC social media handle (Instagram). The video must be on a plain background with no visual/graphic effects or stunts—it must contain only the candidate speaking. The EC may reject any videos that violate the guidelines.
    b. Candidates and campaigners can share the aforementioned posts from their personal accounts for advertising purposes.

c. Candidates as well as campaigners are not allowed to make use of any personal accounts to put out any fresh material that has not already been posted on the aforementioned EC account.

5. Online campaigning would be banned on the following channels:
    a. WhatsApp / Telegram / Instagram / Facebook groups (official and unofficial) of the following nature or similar to the ones listed:
        i. Batch Groups – official and unofficial
        ii. Groups made for communication within the different branches (single and dual degrees)
        iii. Groups made for sharing information about any course (including HuEls, OpEls, etc.)
        iv. Groups made for communication with faculty
        v. Hostel groups
        vi. Club / Department groups – official and unofficial
        vii. SU Connect
    b. Emails on the official BITS ID or personal email IDs of the General Body Members.
    c. Any other social media platforms/websites beyond those listed above are not allowed.
6. The candidate's manifestos and SOP would be released on the EC website.

## SECTION 11 – Manifesto Review Meets

1. Review meets will be held twice every academic year (once per semester) to assess the progress made by the candidate on their declared manifesto points.
2. The candidate shall be required to present evidence of work completed on each manifesto point at the review meet, in the same written/documentary format required under Sections 6.4 and 7.3.
3. If the EC determines that adequate progress has not been made on one or more manifesto points without sufficient justification, the EC may take appropriate punitive action against the candidate, as it deems fit.
4. The nature and extent of the punitive action shall be at the sole discretion of the EC, and its decision in this regard shall be final and binding.